

Santiago Calatrava

Early in his career, the Spanish architect, structural engineer and sculptor Santiago Calatrava (b.1951) raised the status of civil engineering through his designs for bridges and railway stations in his home country. His Montjuic Communications Tower in Barcelona (1991) on the 1992 Olympics site and the Allen Lambert Galleria in Toronto (1992) attracted significant commissions, including the spectacular City of Arts and Sciences in Valencia (1996–2005). Exploiting new technologies, Calatrava creates forms based on nature. His Stadelhofen Railway Station (1990) in Zurich features bridges and roofs above an organic, vaulted, underground arcade. His Quadracci Pavilion (2001) for the Milwaukee Art Museum, an organic, sculptural form resembling a bird about to take flight, functions as a kinetic sun-shield. One of his best-known pieces is the Turning Torso (2005) in Malmö, Sweden. Reaching 190 metres (623 ft) with 54 floors, the Torso is a twisted stack of nine pentagonal segments, each five storeys high and skewed rotationally around the central core, which is braced by an exterior steel framework.



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